P210/2
HISTORY
Paper 2
July 2026
2 hours

ACEITEKA JOINT MOCK EXAMINATIONS 2026

Uganda Advanced Certificate of Education

History Paper 2

(History of World Affairs since 1789)

Time: 2 Hours

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES:

- *This examination paper consists of two sections, A and B.it has three examination items*
- *Answer only two items in all*
- *Section A has one compulsory item*
- *section B has two items. Respond to one item*
- *Respond to two items in all*
- *Any additional item responded to will not be scored*
- *Begin each item on a fresh page*

SECTION A (Compulsory)

ITEM 1

The First World War was a great strain on the Italian and German economies, which led to political and socio-economic chaos in those countries. In Italy, this situation was amplified by her disappointments during the Versailles settlement of 1919, where she didn't achieve any gains as had been promised earlier. Internally, the leadership in Italy was incapable of taking the decisive action the situation demanded. In 1919, Benito Mussolini founded the Italian Fascist Party, which won 35 seats in the 1921 elections. The following year, in an atmosphere of strikes and riots, the fascists staged a 'march on Rome', which culminated in King Victor Emmanuel inviting Benito Mussolini to form a government in October 1922, and he remained in power until July 1943. Similarly, in Germany, Hitler and the Nazi Party offered what seemed to be an attractive alternative just when the republic in Germany was at its most ineffective. The fortunes of the Nazi Party were linked closely to the economic situation, whereby the more unstable the economy was, the more seats the Nazis won in the Reichstag. When Hitler was appointed the Chancellor of Germany by President Hindenburg, his rule lasted until Germany's defeat in 1945. Therefore, between 1922 and 1945, Europe operated under two strange ideologies that were to overturn the entire continent's order.

These ideologies of Fascism and Nazism in Europe, although they introduced a new form of nationalism, were so catastrophic that they fundamentally altered the continent's borders, demographics, politics, and moral landscape. While both ideologies shared a hatred for democracy and human rights, their real-world consequences manifested in devastation across several key areas.

After independence, Africa registered several leaders who became extremists and authoritarians in their respective countries, and their rule left either a positive or a negative impact. Examples of these leaders included Amin of Uganda, Nasser of Egypt, and Gaddafi of Libya, among others. Whereas these leaders communicated a sense of love for their countries, they bred political instability, human rights abuses, civic suppression, and regional destabilization, which have continued to influence order in Africa, either positively or negatively.

Task:

a) Account for the emergence of the two ideologies in Europe as stated in the scenario
b) Assess the impact of extremism and authoritarianism in Africa today.

SECTION B (Choose only one item)

ITEM 2

In the year 1799. France was exhausted by a decade of revolutionary wars, hyperinflation, and political instability. Under these unbearable circumstances, there emerged a brilliant and ambitious military general named Napoleon Bonaparte. Having won popularity through the battlefield victories in Italy and Egypt, he capitalised on this to launch a successful coup d'état, where he rose to power and consolidated his authority first as First Consul, and later, by crowning himself Emperor of the French in 1804. He then reshaped the nation by centralising state power, building a highly efficient bureaucracy, and implementing the Napoleonic Code as a unified legal framework that stabilised the country while cementing his absolute domestic control. With France secure, Napoleon unleashed an aggressive foreign policy aimed at dismantling the traditional European balance of power. Driven by a desire for total continental influence, he expanded the French borders through brilliant tactical strategies, where he repeatedly crushed coalitions of rival monarchies. Napoleon then encountered his primary threat, Great Britain, by establishing the Continental System, an economic blockade that was designed to paralyse British trade. He also forcefully annexed territories and conquered nations into a network of satellite states ruled by his own family members.

However, this overextended foreign policy sparked fierce nationalist resistance, such as the devastating Peninsular War in Spain, a draining conflict that severely bled French military resources. Napoleon's aggressive character reached its fatal point in 1812 with his fateful invasion of Russia, aiming to punish Tsar Alexander I for violating the Continental System. Napoleon's decisive defeat in Russia weakened him so severely that a newly unified coalition of European powers launched a massive counter-offensive and defeated him at the Battle of Leipzig. He lost the support of his war-weary generals and the civilian public. In 1814, he was forced to abdicate his throne and was exiled to the island of Elba, bringing an end to an era of French dominance.

In the country of Tukutuku, there is a leader who has risen to power and transformed his country in accordance with the desires of the masses. However, his foreign policy is becoming so aggressive that the leaders of other countries have decided to overthrow him. This has proved that contemporary aggressive leaders are worthy to be overthrown.

Task:

a) Analyse the downfall of the European leader seen in the scenario by 1814

b) Defend the need to overthrow the contemporary aggressive leaders.

ITEM 3

Russia's defeat led to the signing of the Paris Treaty of 1856, which officially ended the Crimean War. This war was due to a complex political crisis in the Ottoman Empire, caused by the intervention of the European powers into the Ottoman Empire. This treaty provided for the protection of the Christians in the Ottoman Empire, though the clause was later violated by Sultans Abdülaziz and Abdul Hamid II, who persecuted and mistreated Christians. Between 1875 and 1878, the Christians in Bosnia, Herzegovina, and Bulgaria revolted against the bad leadership of Ottoman Sultans, which led to a Russo-Turkish war in 1877 as Russia intended to protect the rights of the Christians. Following the decisive Russian victory over the Ottomans and the subsequent Treaty of San Stefano, the European balance of power was severely disrupted. Russia's creation of a massive, independent Bulgarian state threatened British Mediterranean trade routes and Austro-Hungarian ambitions in the Balkans.

To avert a continental conflict, the German Chancellor Otto von Bismarck invited the Great Powers to the Congress of Berlin in 1878, where he positioned himself as an "honest broker," aiming to settle the disputes through multilateral diplomacy rather than bloodshed. The terms of the Treaty of Berlin split Bulgaria into autonomous regions, which mitigated the Russian threat; made Austria-Hungary gain the right to occupy and administer Bosnia-Herzegovina, gave Britain control of Cyprus, and Montenegro, Serbia, and Romania received formal independence, although their borders were drawn with little regard for ethnic, linguistic, or historical realities.

Today, African countries are constantly challenged by border disputes, secessionist movements, and resource-driven conflicts such as those in the Horn of Africa, the Great Lakes region, or the Sahel. These disputes require everlasting solutions for peace to prevail through diplomatic efforts.

Task:

a) Assess the impact of the 1878 diplomatic Congress on settling European disputes
b) Discuss the relevance of diplomatic resolutions to conflicts in Africa today.

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